

Scandinavia and Finland

THE THREE SCANDINAVIAN countries (Norway, Sweden, and Denmark), along with neighboring Finland, are among the most northerly countries in Europe. Here the winters are long and cold. In the far north, above the Arctic Circle, the Sun remains below the horizon for up to two months a year. Finland is the most densely forested country in Europe, and wood accounts for 30 percent of its exports. All four countries are highly industrialized and are among the wealthiest in the world. In the last few decades, a large number of refugees have found a new home here, and Scandinavia in particular is a lot more ethnically diverse than it used to be.

URBAN POPULATIONS
Scandinavia has a high urban population. Many people live in towns and cities, with less than one-fifth living in the countryside. Since the region is covered in lakes, fjords, and surrounded by sea, many people also live near the water.

Copenhagen in Denmark is the second-largest city in Scandinavia after Stockholm, Sweden.

SKIING
During the winter months, much of Scandinavia is covered with snow, so skiing is a very popular sport.

Sami man in traditional costume

LAPLAND Northern Sweden and Finland are known as Lapland. Here, the local Sami people survive the cold and inhospitable climate by herding reindeer, which they breed for their meat, milk, and skins.

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